

PLATO

428–348 BCE

Foremost among the Greek philosopher-scientists, Plato founded an Academy, the equivalent to a top university, in Athens. Students studied philosophy and science, and worked out in the gymnasium. Plato had a particular interest in the movement of the planets. He could not figure out why some of them moved in loops as they orbited Earth.

A sign over Plato's Academy read, "Let no one ignorant of geometry enter here."

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: Founded an Academy of scientific thought



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Greece



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 387 BCE

